

Kingdom of the Sun

How to Get Sponsors · Instructions for Coach Jones

Pops, this is the simple how-to for landing sponsors. The packet (separate file) is what you send them. This is how you work it. Don't blast it to everyone, work it in order. Five steps.

Step 1 · Start with who you know (warm first)

The fastest yeses come from people who already know you or the program. Before any cold outreach, make a list of: - Committee members' business contacts - Parents and alumni who own or run businesses - Anyone who's supported Vanguard before

Hit these first. A warm intro beats a cold email ten to one.

Step 2 · Then local Ocala businesses

The Community (\$300) and Sideline (\$1,000) tiers are built for these. Go after: - Car dealerships, banks and credit unions - Health systems (AdventHealth, HCA Ocala) - Restaurants and local franchises (Chick-fil-A operators love this) - Sporting goods stores, Chamber of Commerce members

Step 3 · How to actually reach out

- **In person or a call beats email** for local businesses. Drop in, mention the tournament, leave the packet.
- If email: keep it short, attach the packet PDF, ask for a quick call.
- **Personalize the tier.** A small shop = Community. A bank or dealership = Sideline or Court. One big brand could be the Crown.

Step 4 · The 30-second pitch

"Vanguard's hosting the 53rd Annual Kingdom of the Sun this December, it's the original national tournament, 53 years, produced NBA players, and every game streams live on NFHS this year. We've got sponsor spots from \$300 up to title sponsorship. Can I leave you the one-pager?"

Let the packet do the rest.

Step 5 · Work it like a pipeline (don't chase)

- **One follow-up** if they don't reply in a week. Then move on. Never chase.
 - **When someone says yes:** get their logo (high-res), confirm payment, and note which tier and what they get.
 - **Send me every yes** and I'll track it, deliver their logo to the website, and make sure they get their recap proof after the event. That recap is what makes them renew next year.
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A few rules

- **Don't undersell.** The \$300 Community tier is the easy entry, but a dealership or hospital can do Court (\$2,500). Read the room.
 - **Land logos first.** Year one, getting recognizable names on the wall matters more than maxing every dollar. Year two prices itself up.
 - **Keep it clean.** Sponsor money is tournament money, separate from anything else.
 - **You set the prices.** The packet numbers are starting points; adjust if you need to.
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What I handle (so you don't have to)

Once you send me a confirmed sponsor: I put their logo on the site, build their recap proof, and keep the tracker. You close them, I deliver them. Same as everything else, you push, I build.